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TUESDAY, JUNE 17, 2025

US judge declares NIH cuts illegal, void

Accuses department of bias; ruling affects hundreds of grants

By Chris Serres
GLOBE STAFF

In a harshly worded ruling Monday, a federal judge in Boston accused the Trump administration of discrimination

against minorities and LGBTQ+ individuals and ordered the

National Institutes of Health, the world's largest funder of biomedical research, to reinstate hundreds of research grants, declaring the agency's termination of them "illegal and void."

The decision, which came in a two-hour hearing over two lawsuits against the Trump administration, is a major victory for scientists across the country who are reeling from billions of dollars in NIH funding cuts.

While judges have previously intervened to temporarily block the Trump administration's cuts, Monday's ruling marks a pivotal step in efforts to halt, or at least slow, the assault on scientific research. It marks the first time a judge has ordered the NIH to restore canceled funding, legal experts said. It also marks the first time a federal judge has explicitly argued that the Trump administration's cuts to NIH research grants are

NIH, Page A10

Red Sox brass defend move to trade Devers

Officials say player's refusal to play first damaged relationship

By Alex Speier
GLOBE STAFF

One day after a stunning trade that sent star slugger Rafael Devers to the San Francisco Giants in exchange for four players, Red Sox officials discussed the deal.

Chief baseball officer Craig Breslow and president/chief executive Sam Kennedy explained the trade as a product of the team's failure to see eye-to-eye with Devers, implicitly suggesting his refusal to play first base after a season-ending injury to Triston Casas in early May fractured his relationship with the organization.

"In terms of what was missing, it just was that alignment in terms of what we felt we needed from him that would be in

TRADE, Page C2

Dealing with it

For Sox fans, the shock of trading one of the team's cornerstones is an all-too-familiar sensation. **C1.**



AZIZ BABANEZHAD/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Mourners carried the flag-draped coffins of five men during their funeral in the city of Khorramabad, Iran, Monday. The men were reportedly killed in Israeli strikes.

As Israel attacks, residents flee

Escalation includes strikes on covert headquarters; exodus from Tehran follows warnings

By Farnaz Fassihi, Aaron Boxerman, and Gabby Sobelman
NEW YORK TIMES

Israel escalated its bombings across Iran on Monday, striking Iran's elite military force and the nation's state broadcaster and sending thousands fleeing from Tehran, as its offensive entered its fourth day and showed no signs of slowing.

Some of Israel's attack was televised. On Monday evening, an Iranian state news anchor was live on air when an explosion shook the scene, causing falling debris and the sound of screams and breaking glass. Iranian state media said the blast injured some employees, disabled its website, and forced the broadcaster briefly off air.

In what is likely to be a more consequential strike, Israel also bombed the Tehran command center of the Quds Force, one of the most important and covert arms of Iran's military. The force largely runs Iran's foreign operations — including training and arming its proxy groups, such as Hezbollah in Lebanon and Hamas in the Gaza Strip — and any disruption could be a significant blow to Iran's military capabilities and regional reach.

Iran fired a barrage of missiles toward Israel on Sunday and Monday, including a strike on Israel's largest oil refin-



AVISHAG SHAAR-YASHUV/THE NEW YORK TIMES

ery, although many were intercepted by Israeli air defenses.

Israel's expansion of its strikes — from nuclear and military targets to energy infrastructure and a government broadcaster — showed that this offensive is different from Israel's more targeted attacks against Iran in recent years.

Israel appears to be pouncing on an Iran weakened by nearly two years of blows against its military might, includ-

MIDEAST, Page A7

Men surveyed the damage to a school building in Bnei Brak, Israel, after an Iranian missile strike on Monday.

'Simplification does not help out billionaires, and this bill is designed to help billionaires.'

SENATOR ELIZABETH WARREN, *Massachusetts Democrat*

Trump's big tax bill may be a big filing headache

By Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — A major thrust of the Republicans' sweeping 2017 tax law was simplifying the tax code, with the ambitious goal — ultimately unrealized — of allowing average Americans to file on a form the size of a postcard.

This year's massive tax bill, currently moving through Congress, does just the opposite. And nobody's mentioned anything about a postcard-sized form this time.

Republican lawmakers have worked to fulfill President Trump's 2024 campaign promises of eliminating taxes on tips, overtime pay, and So-

cial Security benefits. At the same time, they've had to include other provisions to nail down votes within the historically slim Republican House majority.

All of that has helped swell the One Big Beautiful Bill Act to 1,038 pages. At more than five times the size of the 2017 Tax Cuts and Jobs Act, it is also

one big complicated bill.

Experts said the addition of numerous temporary tax breaks provides new ways for people to try to game the system while making it more difficult for everyday Americans to file their returns. The average user of the standard 1040 form spent \$290 and 13

TAX BILL, Page A10



A dank account

Tuesday: Damp and drizzly.

High 65-70, low 59-64.

Wednesday: Scattered storm.

High 77-82, low 66-71.

Sunrise: 5:07. Sunset: 8:24.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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The suspect in the killing of a Minnesota lawmaker and the wounding of another approached the homes of two other legislators on the night of the attacks, a prosecutor said, **A2.**

Cambridge-based Sarepta Therapeutics halted shipments of its Duchenne muscular dystrophy gene therapy following the death of a second person who received the treatment. **D1.**

State lawmakers forged a deal to give the MBTA \$535 million from a spending package built on extra money generated by the state's surtax on high-earners. **B1.**

Striking staff shut down the Louvre, the world's most-visited museum, with too much tourism a complaint. **A3.**

The ~~Pine~~ Profane Tree State

Maine has a new license plate. A close look elicits more than a few chuckles.

By Steve Greenlee
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

PORTLAND — Maine is rolling out new license plates, and some motorists are seeing an extra digit on them.

The state began issuing new plates May 1 to replace the ones bearing a chickadee that have been the standard plates here since 1999. The 1.2 million vehicle owners with chickadee plates have two choices for their new plates when it comes time to renew their registrations: one featuring a pine tree and star, and one with no image.

Most people are taking the tree — by a 10-to-1 ratio. But a lot of people are seeing more than a mere conifer.

It took Alison Soule a nanosecond to see it.



STEVE GREENLEE FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Maine has replaced the chickadee with one of its iconic pine trees on the license plate. Some see an iconic gesture among the upper needles.

"Oh, it's a middle finger," Soule, 46, said when she looked closely at the new plates she'd put on her SUV two weeks earlier.

Soule, a teacher and restaurant worker who lives in North Yarmouth, said getting flipped off by a treetop doesn't bother her. "It's actually funny," she said. "If it was done intentionally, that's disappointing. If it was accidental, it's more comical."

Was it intentional? Or is the image like a Rorschach test inkblot, where we see what we want to see?

It's the latter, says the artist who designed the plate.

Mary Catus was working in the Maine secretary of state's office in 2023 when it was charged with com-

PLATES, Page A6